



New gTLDs

Vanity plates on the Internet

ICANN has finally opened the gates to hundreds of new gTLDs. While the one you want might not be available at the moment, it won't long before it will be

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Getting vanity plates for vehicles is something we Indians don't get to experience. There are VIP numbers which cost an awful lot of money and we've read about special plates going for as high as ₹17 lakh if more than one person bids for it. While vanity number plates may continue to be a dream for the average person, a vanity domain name may not be. ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers), the authority on everything related to domains and the registrars that maintain them had only 22 TLDs (Top Level Domains) available till now. So everyone had to stick to a .com or .net or any of the 20 other domains available. Now that the plan for implementing gTLDs has finally come to fruition, we are going to see some creative new names arising.

What's a gTLD?

gTLD stands for Generic Top Level Domain. So instead of a .com or a .in you'll now be able to apply for a .personal or a .enterprises URL. ICANN is in the process of allowing companies to come forth and apply for new gTLDs. There is a gruelling evaluation session in the process to check for popularity and feasibility before they approve a new gTLD and assign a registrar to manage the same. The entire process can take two or more years and this began back in 2011 so now we

are about to see the launch of these new gTLDs. And by the end of 2014 there will literally be 100s of new gTLDs to choose from. Think about it in this manner, what if you could have a new gTLD just for your industry. If you're into landscaping and your company is named Triksy's then you could have a domain name as "tricksys.gardens" or if you have a restaurant then you could have a domain "yourrestaurant-name.menu" which would take people



directly to a menu page and have the option to order from there. Now think if there are restaurants all over the city and everyone decides to buy a .menu domain, looking up any restaurant's menu is all about typing the name of the restaurant and then adding .menu at the end.

The same goes on for the hundreds of different industries out there. The pos-

sibilities are numerous. The image on the right gives you a little list of all the new gTLDs available along with the rates they are selling for.

What's in it for you?

1. A plethora of options

Till now there have only been 22 gTLDs but by the end of this year you will have hundreds to pick from. You will have gTLDs suited for your business that makes it every the more easier to remember a website URL. Moreover, with more options the competition between the registrars that manage the gTLDs increases. This means you get cheaper domain names after the initial period. Also, if that URL you always wanted was taken then this is the chance to buy one with a gTLD suited for your business. This makes for a better URL than a normal .com or .net

2. Brand recall

Like we said, it becomes easier to remember a URL with a multitude of choices. If you own a resort then a prospective patron could simply type your resort's name and then add .resort to the end of it to land on your web page, i.e. if you've bothered to buy the domain.

3. Prevent squatting

With the introduction of more gTLDs comes the prospect of more and more scammers hoping to swoop in on your brand name and buy a domain. Squatting is usually followed by offers to sell the